

10.4 Other Fun Stuff

There's a whole bunch of cool open source tools out there designed to make your computing experience a whole lot more enjoyable. Here's a look at a few of them.

10.4.1 Launchy

Launchy is the open source answer to Google Desktop, except it's got a much snazzier interface. It is designed to help you find whatever program, document, image, etc. you're looking for on your computer, without having to open a ton of folders.

It allows you to configure its search for various folders and file types on your computer. By default, it will, on first install, only search for programs on your Start Menu. However, you can add as many folders and



It's convenient—and right on your desktop

file types as you like, and you can even specify these settings for each folder, that is, if you want to search for JPG files in your My Documents folder, but not in your Program Files folder, you can select that file type specifically for your My Documents folder.

When you hit [Alt] + [Spacebar] on your Desktop, the interface will open in a little bar with a text input location on your Desktop. As soon as you start typing, it will show you results for various software. You can edit the options for Launchy by right-clicking on the interface bar. You can edit the skins here as well, and change the hotkey for accessing the program.

OS: Windows

Web site: www.launchy.net